

Etienne Bacher

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EMPLOYMENT

April 2026 – current	Research Software Engineer	University College London, UK
	• I work on Palaeoverse, a community-driven initiative advancing open science in palaeobiology through shared tools, training, and resources. • I help developing and maintaining R packages and other resources to train researchers in palaeobiology to good practices in software development.	
May 2025 – Jan. 2026	Research Associate	LISER, Luxembourg
	• I worked on the INSKILL project, specifically on mapping AI adoption in Europe through big data. • I used a High-Performance Computer to apply machine learning methods and Large Language Models on millions of websites of European companies to determine their AI usage.	

EDUCATION

2020 – 2024	PhD in Economics	LISER, Luxembourg
	• Topic: “Cross-border labor mobility, attitudes and political preferences” • Thesis committee: Michel Tenikue, Michel Beine, Hillel Rapoport	
2024 (April – June)	Visiting PhD student at the London School of Economics (sponsor: Dr. Sandra Sequeira)	London, UK
2018 – 2020	Master’s Degree in Development Economics	CERDI, Clermont-Ferrand, France
2017 – 2018	Bachelor’s Degree in Development Economics	CERDI, Clermont-Ferrand, France

COMPUTER SKILLS

Advanced: R

- Author or maintainer of several R packages: [datawizard](#), [tidypolars](#), [flir](#).
- Significant contributions to several R packages: [marginaleffects](#), [polars](#), [insight](#).
- Teaching:
 - Center for Applied Public Economics, Brussels (January 2026): workshop on handling large data with R and Python.
 - University of Innsbruck (May 2025): 3-day workshop on webscraping and handling large data with R and Python.
 - LISER (2022, 2023): workshop on “Webscraping with RSelenium”, handling large data with Python and R, using version control for research projects, applying good research practices with R.

Intermediate: Python, Rust

- Author of [Jarl](#), an R linter written in Rust.
- Used Python for large-scale data handling (Polars), webscraping, machine learning, web application.

Other: Stata, LaTeX, Ubuntu/Linux.

WORKING PAPERS

- “Populist leaders and international migration”
- “Migrant voices”, with [Martín Fernández](#)
- “Estimating the impact of xenophobia on immigration: evidence from terrorist attacks”, with [Michel Beine](#) and [Hillel Rapoport](#)

PUBLICATIONS

1. Brodeur, A., Mikola, D., Cook, N., ..., **Bacher, E.**, ... (2026). Reproducibility and robustness of economics and political science research. *Nature*, 652, 151–156, <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-026-10251-x>
2. **Bacher, E.**, Herrera-Rodriguez, M., Marino Fages, D., Stips, F., (2023). A Replication of Jones & Marinescu (2022), *I4R Discussion Paper Series* n°80
3. Patil, I., Makowski, D., Ben-Shachar, M. S., Wiernik, B., **Bacher, E.**, Lüdecke, D., (2022). datawizard: An R Package for Easy Data Preparation and Statistical Transformations. *Journal of Open Source Software*, 7(78), 4684, <https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.04684>

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

2024: Workshop on “The Economic, Social and Political Effects of Migration” (Leiden), Online Junior Seminar on the Economics of Migration, 8th Conference on “Understanding voluntary and forced migration”, LSE Graduate Economic History Seminar, 2nd Junior Workshop on the Economics of Migration, European Economic Association-ESEM

2023: Canazei Winter School on Inequality, Social Norms, and Migration, “Migration and Politics: Current and Future Challenges” workshop, LISER internal seminar

2022: “Globalization, Attitudes and Populism” workshop, 1st LUX-ERC workshop

2021: Population Association of America (Discussant)

OTHER ACTIVITIES

- Co-organizer of the [online Economics of Migration Junior seminar](#) (2021-2024)
- Member of the scientific committee of the (in-person) Junior Workshop on the Economics of Migration (2023, 2024)
- Referee: *International Journal of Manpower*
- Teaching Assistant in International Economics (Fall 2021, 2022, 2023), *3rd year Bachelor* (Prof. Michel Beine)

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

2020 (2 months)	Internship as research assistant	CERDI, Clermont-Ferrand, France
	• Built a dataset on the sovereignty of small islands. • Created an application with R Shiny to explore this dataset.	
2019 (2 months)	Internship as research assistant	High-Commission for Planning, Rabat, Morocco
	• Production of a report: “Labor market and poverty in Morocco” (in French & English) • Made the literature review, treated survey data, applied econometric methods using Stata on about 200,000 observations, and contributed to the writing.	

LANGUAGES

French (native), English (fluent, IELTS: 8.5), Spanish (basic)